

ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FCS vs FBS · Week 1 Matchups · 2026

Model spread = FBS Comp – FCS Comp + 2.80 HFA (FBS home). Green = upset window (spread < 14). Amber = soft FBS host (14–21). FCS comp: Sagarin 2025 adj. FBS comp: 70% SP+ _scaled + 30% Sagarin.

All FCS vs FBS Week 1 Games (33 matchups)

Vegas does not post lines for most FCS-FBS games — model spread is your sharp reference.

Date	TV	FCS Team	FCS Comp	FBS Team	FBS Comp	Ntrl	Model Spread	Vegas	Sharp Note
Sat 8/29	CBSSN	Jacksonville State	40.0	NDSU	71.7	N	NDSU -34.5	TBD	—
Thu 9/3	ESPN+	UAlbany	37.5	Buffalo	58.6	N	Buffalo -23.9	TBD	Buffalo -16 model.
Thu 9/3	ESPN+	Bethune-Cookman	39.0	UCF	71.1	N	UCF -34.9	TBD	—
Thu 9/3	ESPN+	Merrimack	38.0	Delaware	58.4	N	Delaware -23.2	TBD	—
Thu 9/3	ESPN+	West Georgia	53.0	Kennesaw State	61.8	N	Kennesaw State -11.6	TBD	★★★ KSU (C-USA yr 1) comp 63.4. WG comp 53.0. If KSU -17+, WG +17 is value.
Thu 9/3	SEC Net.	Ark.-Pine Bluff	30.0	Missouri	83.2	N	Missouri -56.0	TBD	Missouri -50 model.
Thu 9/3	Peacock	Eastern Illinois	38.5	Minnesota	75.0	N	Minnesota -39.3	TBD	—
Thu 9/3	ESPN+	Idaho	51.0	Utah	83.2	N	Utah -35.0	TBD	★★ Utah SP+ 11.9, Sag 86.80. Model Utah -38. If -42+, Idaho has value.
Fri 9/4	ESPN+	NC A&T;	29.0	Georgia State	49.0	N	Georgia State -22.8	TBD	Georgia State -24 model.
Fri 9/4	Big Ten	Indiana State	44.0	Purdue	66.9	N	Purdue -25.7	TBD	★★ Purdue -25 model. Purdue Sag only 63.58. If market -28+, fade Purdue.
Fri 9/4	ESPNU	LIU	42.0	Kansas	73.3	N	Kansas -34.1	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	N/A	Lafayette	49.0	UConn	62.1	N	UConn -15.9	TBD	UConn -21 model. Large gap.
Sat 9/5	CBSSN	Bryant	39.0	Army	68.4	N	Army -32.2	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	MW+	Duquesne	44.0	Air Force	66.5	N	Air Force -25.3	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Tarleton State	67.5	Bowling Green	57.6	N	Tarleton State -7.1	TBD	★★★ TARLETON FAVOURED. BG home may open -7 to -14. 6-12 pt edge on WAC powerhouse.
Sat 9/5	ESPN	New Hampshire	51.0	Syracuse	67.6	N	Syracuse -19.4	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN	Youngstown State	59.0	Kentucky	73.9	N	Kentucky -17.7	TBD	★ YSU comp 59 vs KY comp 74. Model KY -18. Standard cupcake.
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	SE Missouri State	43.0	Iowa State	73.2	N	Iowa State -33.0	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Rhode Island	55.5	Temple	62.0	N	Temple -9.3	TBD	★★ RI comp 55.5 vs Temple 61.9. Model Temple -9. If -14+, RI +14 is value.

Date	TV	FCS Team	FCS Comp	FBS Team	FBS Comp	Ntrl	Model Spread	Vegas	Sharp Note
Sat 9/5	SEC+	Tennessee State	34.5	Georgia	92.5	N	Georgia -60.8	TBD	Georgia -55+ model. Largest blowout of weekend.
Sat 9/5	ESPN	Furman	43.5	Tennessee	83.9	N	Tennessee -43.2	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	The Citadel	44.0	Charlotte	43.8	N	Charlotte -2.6	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	CBSSN	Towson	46.5	Navy	72.1	N	Navy -28.4	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	UTRGV	51.5	UTSA	70.1	N	UTSA -21.4	TBD	UTSA -25 model. Blowout expected.
Sat 9/5	CW Net.	Fordham	49.5	NDSU	71.7	N	NDSU -25.0	TBD	NDSU (new FBS) model -12. Standard new-FBS test.
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Maine	46.5	App State	58.5	N	App State -14.8	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN	North Alabama	49.5	Arkansas	74.6	N	Arkansas -27.9	TBD	Arkansas -28 model.
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Alcorn State	35.5	Southern Miss	70.7	N	Southern Miss -38.0	TBD	—
Sat 9/5	ESPN	Austin Peay	55.5	Vanderbilt	81.6	N	Vanderbilt -28.9	TBD	Vanderbilt -33 model.
Sat 9/5	FS1	Abilene Christian	58.5	Texas Tech	91.5	N	Texas Tech -35.8	TBD	★★ QB CRISIS: Sorsby gone (gambling). Hammond ACL, Week 1 uncertain. Backup Jones III likely starts. TT effective ~82. If Vegas -28+, ACU cover live.
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Nicholls	45.5	Kansas State	79.1	N	Kansas State -36.4	TBD	Kansas State -33 model.
Sat 9/5	ESPN	Missouri State	48.0	Texas A&M;	88.2	N	Texas A&M; -43.0	Texas A&M; -38.5	A&M; -38.5 opened. Model A&M; -36. Near model — pass.
Sat 9/5	ESPN+	Norfolk State	36.5	Old Dominion	67.5	N	Old Dominion -33.8	TBD	—

Top FCS Upset Candidates

★★★ Tarleton State at Bowling Green: Tarleton composite 67.5 (WAC powerhouse, 12-2 in 2025) vs Bowling Green composite 62.4 (MAC, 4-8). Model makes TARLETON the FAVOURITE even as a road team. If Vegas opens BG at home -7 to -14, this is the single largest FCS upset value play of the entire weekend. ★★★ West Georgia at Kennesaw State: KSU (C-USA, first full FBS year) only rates 63.4 composite. WG composite 53.0 is a legitimate WAC FCS team. If market opens KSU -17+, West Georgia +17 is strong value. ★★ Indiana State at Purdue: Purdue model spread -25. Purdue went 2-10 in 2025 with a Sagarin of only 63.58. If Vegas inflates to -30+, back Indiana State to cover.